MalikTrades

COMMON MISTAKES

The fourteen I see most, and how to fix them

THE PLAYBOOK

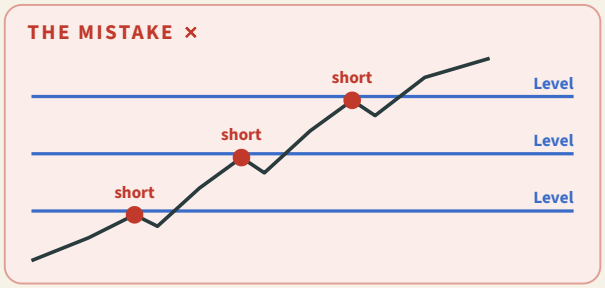
PART 01

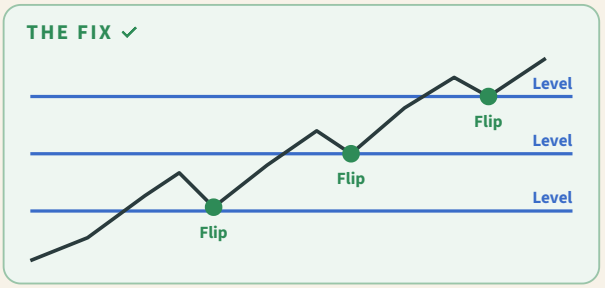
Reading the Market

Taking the right setup on the wrong day.

01 Fading a trend day

Price keeps building volume above the dVAH or below the dVAL, the dPOC keeps moving the same way, and you keep trying to Snap against it.





WHY IT COSTS YOU

Every level you try to fade just gets broken. One stop turns into two or three.

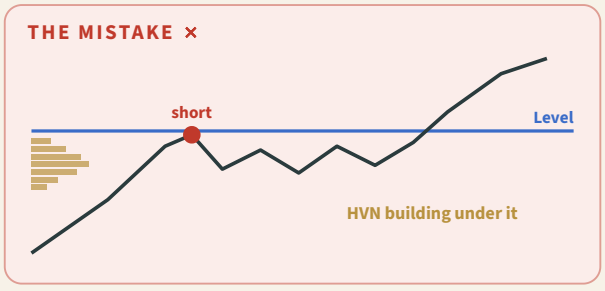
THE FIX

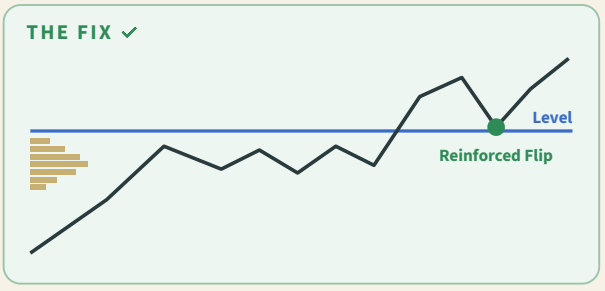
Read the shape first. On a trend day the Flip and the Magnet are higher probability, and Snaps against it are lower probability.

See: VP Academy #04: Profile Shapes

02 Snapping into an HVN

Price ranges just above or below your level and an HVN starts building there. You take the Snap anyway because the level is marked.





WHY IT COSTS YOU

The HVN is pressure building on a ceiling. More often than not, the level breaks.

THE FIX

Treat it as a lower-probability Snap. Wait for the break and the retest instead: the Reinforced Flip, where the HVN becomes a wall behind you.

See: Bonus Tips: Scenario 02

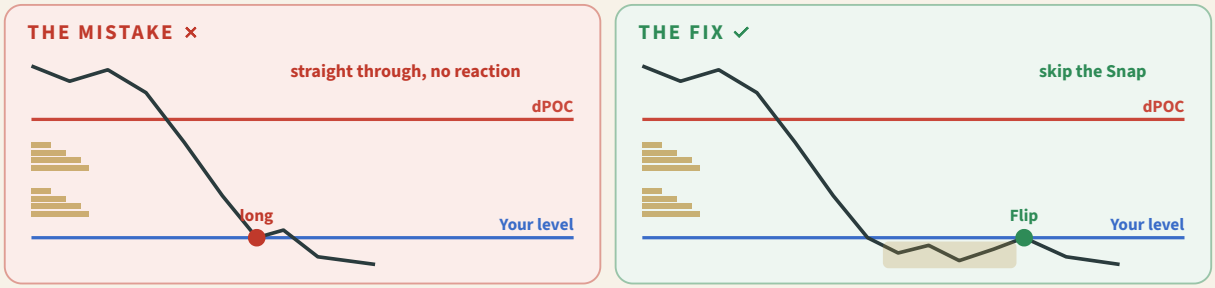
PART 01

Reading the Market

Taking the right setup on the wrong day.

03 Fading after price slices through the dPOC

On the way to your level, price cuts straight through the dPOC and every HVN without reacting, and you fade the level anyway.



WHY IT COSTS YOU

The dPOC and the HVNs are where the most volume is. If price cuts through them with no reaction, it's actively looking for new fair value, so fading against that move is lower probability.

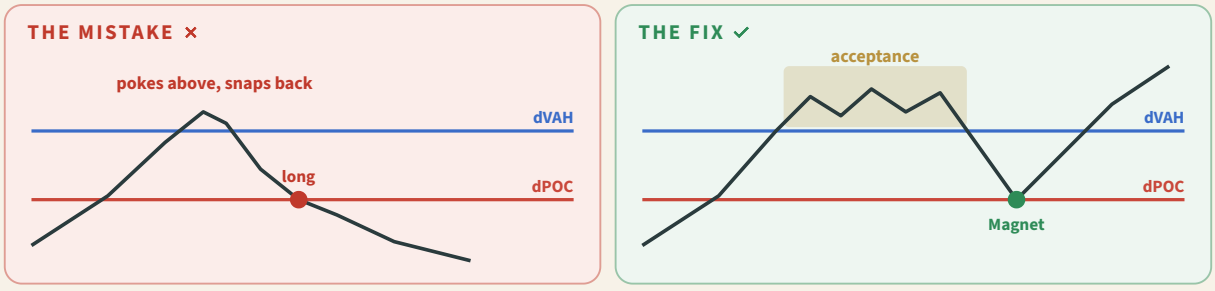
THE FIX

Treat it as a lower-probability Snap and let it go. If price breaks your level and builds acceptance beyond it, look for the Flip instead.

See: Bonus Tips: Scenario 03

04 A Magnet with no acceptance

Price pokes past the dVAH or dVAL, snaps straight back, and you take the dPOC retest as a Magnet.



WHY IT COSTS YOU

The market rejected those prices. There's no direction to continue, so the dPOC is just the middle of the range.

THE FIX

Only take the Magnet when volume has built beyond the dVAH or dVAL. Acceptance first, then the dPOC retest.

See: Bonus Tips: Scenario 04

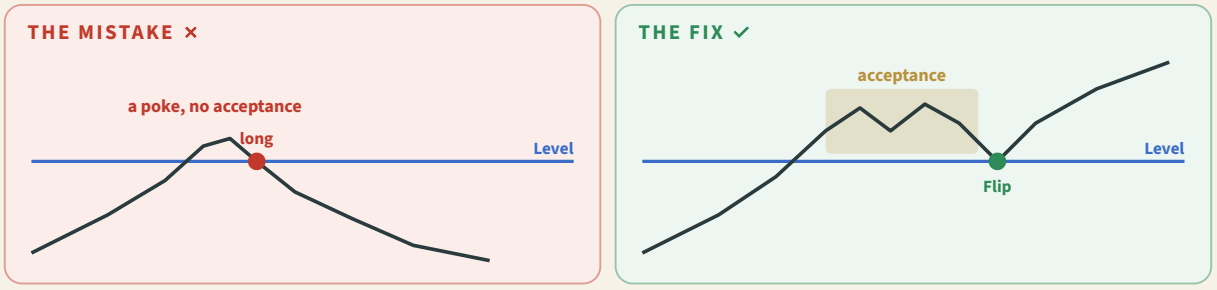
PART 01

Reading the Market

Taking the right setup on the wrong day.

05 A Flip with no acceptance

Price pokes through a level and you take the retest straight away, but no volume has built beyond it.



WHY IT COSTS YOU

Without acceptance, the break is just a poke. Price often falls back through the level and your Flip turns into a fade against you.

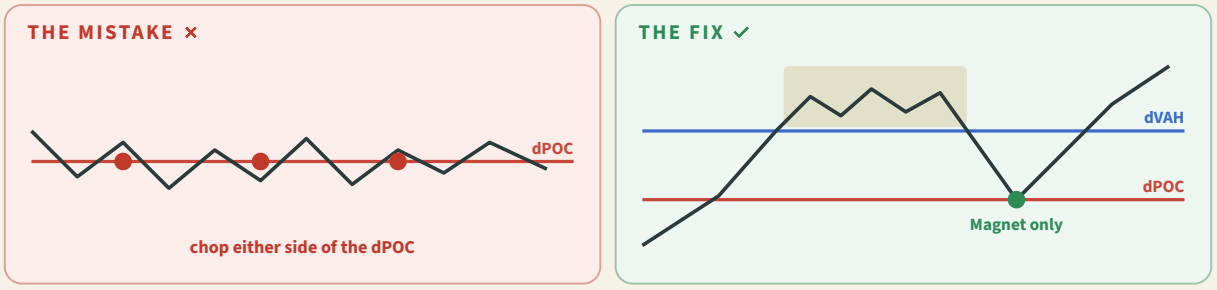
THE FIX

Only take the Flip once volume has built beyond the level. Acceptance first, then the retest.

See: Core Setups: The Flip

06 Trading the dPOC outside the Magnet

Price touches the dPOC and you fade it or buy it, with no acceptance beyond the dVAH or dVAL first.



WHY IT COSTS YOU

The dPOC is where the most business is getting done today, so price chops back and forth through it. It's a very noisy place to trade.

THE FIX

The only trade I take at the dPOC is the Magnet: acceptance beyond the dVAH or dVAL, then back to the dPOC. No other time.

See: Core Setups: The Magnet

PART 01

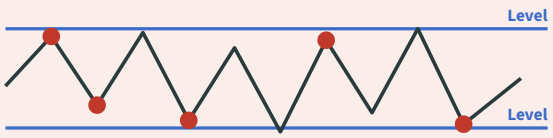
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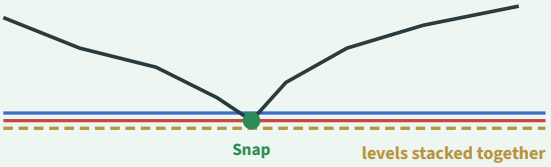
07 Trading the chop

Two or three levels sit a little apart from each other, and you trade every touch between them.

THE MISTAKE ×



THE FIX ✓



WHY IT COSTS YOU

Both levels matter, so price can't decide between them and ranges in the gap. You get chopped up on both sides.

THE FIX

Step aside when levels are a little apart. When they're very close together, they stack into a higher-grade zone instead, and that's a trade worth taking.

See: Bonus Tips: Scenario 01

KEY TAKEAWAY

Most of these come down to one question you skipped: did the market accept the price, or reject it? Read that first, and most of these mistakes disappear.

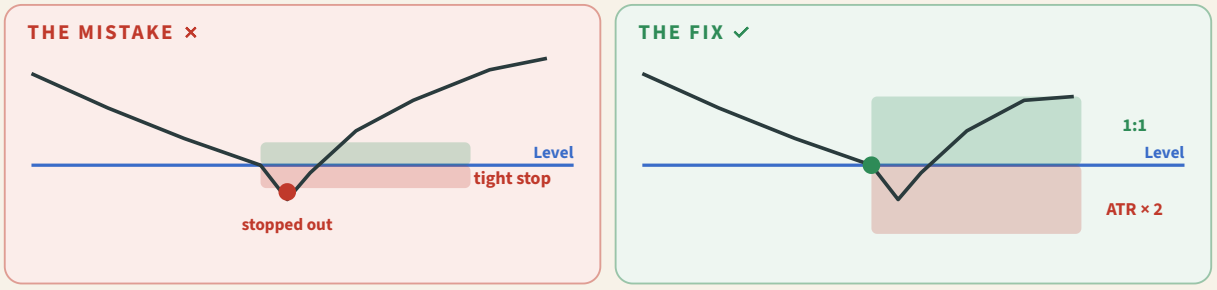
PART 02

Execution

A good read, let down by the orders.

08 Stop too tight

You use a small stop on gold or oil because it feels safer, and get wicked out just before price reacts.



WHY IT COSTS YOU

GC and CL often wick through a level before reacting. A tight stop is inside the noise, so you're right on direction and still lose.

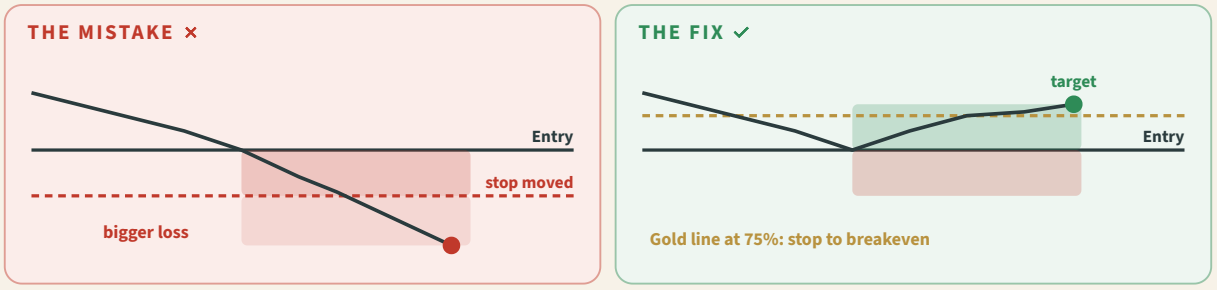
THE FIX

Use ATR × 2 points on gold and oil, read at the moment you place the order. It gives the trade room to breathe.

See: VP Academy #06 and #07

09 Moving the stop or target

Price comes towards your stop, so you widen it. Or price is in profit, so you close early before 1:1.



WHY IT COSTS YOU

Widening turns a planned loss into a bigger one. Closing early cuts your winners below your losers, and a 65–70% win rate stops being enough.

THE FIX

Set the stop and target when you place the order. The only adjustment is moving your stop to breakeven at 75% of the way to your target.

See: VP Academy #07: Execution

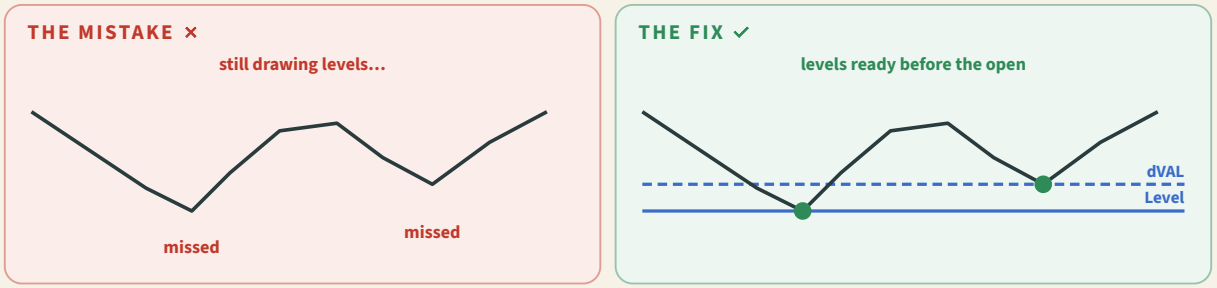
PART 03

Discipline

The mistakes that have nothing to do with the chart.

10 Not marking levels before the session

The session starts and you're still drawing profiles, setting VWAP and finding ATR while price is moving.



WHY IT COSTS YOU

You're scrambling instead of watching. Setups come and go while you're still getting ready, and you miss them.

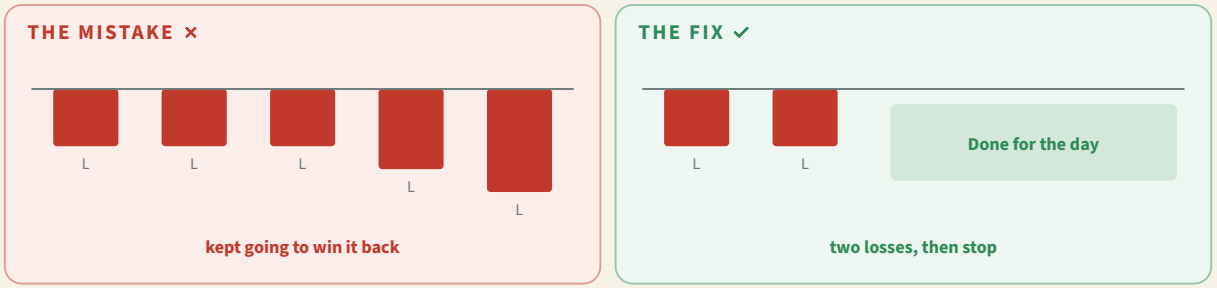
THE FIX

Run the pre-session checklist before you start trading: levels marked, developing profile on Extend Right, VWAP and bands set, ATR on.

See: VP Academy #08: Putting It All Together

11 Revenge trading

Two losses in, you keep trading to win it back.



WHY IT COSTS YOU

Every trade after that is driven by the losses, not by the setup. A bad day becomes a blown account.

THE FIX

Two losses and you're done on that account for the day. The next session is a clean slate. If it's getting to you, open the Mindset tool.

See: VP Academy #07: Execution

PART 03

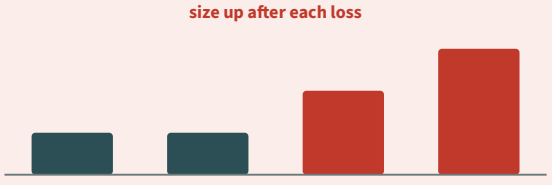
Discipline

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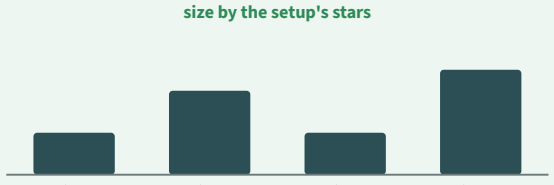
12 Oversizing

After a loss, you size up on the next trade to make it back faster, whatever the setup looks like.

THE MISTAKE ×



THE FIX ✓



WHY IT COSTS YOU

Your losses get bigger exactly when you're trading worst. One more loss at the bigger size can undo a week.

THE FIX

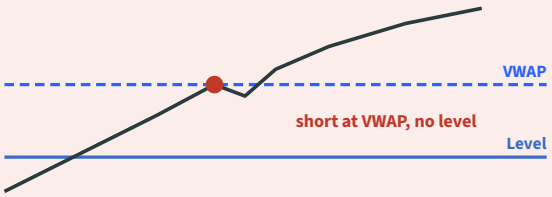
Size by the setup, never by your last result. A 1-star setup gets less risk (1 contract). 2 stars and above get more (2 contracts, and so on).

See: Prop Firm Hacking Tool

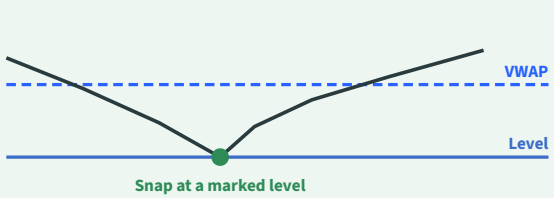
13 Forcing invalid setups

Nothing has set up, so you take a trade that doesn't meet the criteria: VWAP with no level behind it, a Flip with no acceptance, a dPOC trade that isn't a Magnet.

THE MISTAKE ×



THE FIX ✓



WHY IT COSTS YOU

A trade that doesn't meet the criteria isn't one of our setups, so it has none of their edge. Boredom trades add losses without adding anything.

THE FIX

If it isn't a valid Snap, Flip or Magnet at a marked level, it isn't a trade. Three or four setups a session is normal, and some sessions give you fewer.

See: Core Setups

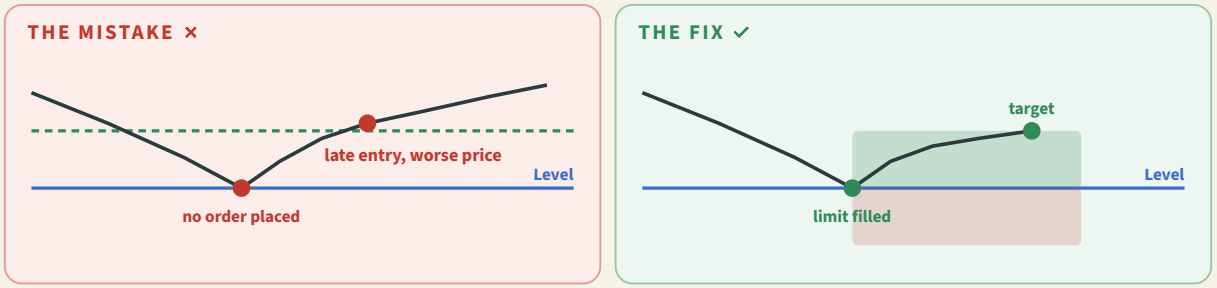
PART 03

Discipline

The mistakes that have nothing to do with the chart.

14 Hesitating on valid setups

Every criterion is met, but you second-guess it. You don't place the order, or you enter late after price has already moved.



WHY IT COSTS YOU

Your 65–70% win rate comes from taking every valid setup. Skip the ones that feel scary and you skip winners, and entering late gives you a worse price than the one you planned.

THE FIX

If the criteria are met, place the limit order at the level and let it play out. The edge shows up over many trades, not on any single one.

See: VP Academy #07: Execution

WHAT SEPARATES WINNERS FROM LOSERS

> *His winning and losing traders took 80–90% of the same winning trades. The losing traders just took far more losing trades.*

Mark Hutchinson · Founder of Falcon FX (paraphrased)

In other words, the losers took more **invalid setups** and hesitated on the **valid ones**. Take every valid setup, skip every invalid one, and let the setup decide your size.

SUMMARY

All Fourteen on One Page

Mistake, and the fix.

	MISTAKE	THE FIX
01	**Fading a trend day**	Read the shape first. On a trend day the Flip and the Magnet are higher probability, and Snaps against it are lower probability.
02	**Snapping into an HVN**	Treat it as a lower-probability Snap. Wait for the break and the retest instead: the Reinforced Flip, where the HVN becomes a wall behind you.
03	**Fading after price slices through the dPOC**	Treat it as a lower-probability Snap and let it go. If price breaks your level and builds acceptance beyond it, look for the Flip instead.
04	**A Magnet with no acceptance**	Only take the Magnet when volume has built beyond the dVAH or dVAL. Acceptance first, then the dPOC retest.
05	**A Flip with no acceptance**	Only take the Flip once volume has built beyond the level. Acceptance first, then the retest.
06	**Trading the dPOC outside the Magnet**	The only trade I take at the dPOC is the Magnet: acceptance beyond the dVAH or dVAL, then back to the dPOC. No other time.
07	**Trading the chop**	Step aside when levels are a little apart. When they're very close together, they stack into a higher-grade zone instead, and that's a trade worth taking.
08	**Stop too tight**	Use ATR × 2 points on gold and oil, read at the moment you place the order. It gives the trade room to breathe.
09	**Moving the stop or target**	Set the stop and target when you place the order. The only adjustment is moving your stop to breakeven at 75% of the way to your target.
10	**Not marking levels before the session**	Run the pre-session checklist before you start trading: levels marked, developing profile on Extend Right, VWAP and bands set, ATR on.
11	**Revenge trading**	Two losses and you're done on that account for the day. The next session is a clean slate. If it's getting to you, open the Mindset tool.
12	**Oversizing**	Size by the setup, never by your last result. A 1-star setup gets less risk (1 contract). 2 stars and above get more (2 contracts, and so on).
13	**Forcing invalid setups**	If it isn't a valid Snap, Flip or Magnet at a marked level, it isn't a trade. Three or four setups a session is normal, and some sessions give you fewer.
14	**Hesitating on valid setups**	If the criteria are met, place the limit order at the level and let it play out. The edge shows up over many trades, not on any single one.

Education only, not financial advice.